

Miners Get Pair With Timely Plays

Timely pitching, pinpoint hitting and a game-saving fielding gem lifted the University of Texas at El Paso to a 4-3, 5-2 sweep of a doubleheader over Lubbock Christian College Tuesday at Tech Field.

The Miners were leading 4-1 in the opener until the Chapparals closed to within one run in the seventh inning and had the tying and winning runners on third and second respectively with only one out.

Reliever K.C. Nix, who had come into the game to strike out two batters with runners on second and third, got himself into trouble in the seventh but caught LCC's Steve Brigante looking at three pitches for the second out.

Lubbock Christian's Kenny Toney then looped a short fly ball behind Dan McMahon at shortstop. McMahon turned his back to the infield and made a running over-the-head catch to end the game.

"That was some play," praised Miner Coach Andy Cohen after the Miners raised their record to 9-3. "McMahon saved the game for us and Nix didn't do a bad job coming in and getting us out of trouble."

McMahon produced UTEP's first run in the second inning with a single to right after freshman Art Flores had walked, moved to second on a sacrifice bunt and stolen third.

LCC tied the score at 1-1 in the top of the third but Dan Feagler, the hitting star in the nightcap, slammed the first of his two homers for the day over left-centerfield for a 3-1 Miner lead after three.

UTEP added a run in the bottom of the fourth, giving starting pitcher Jerry Walker his first win of the season. Walker left the game after the fourth, complaining of a sore pitching arm.

Lubbock Christian, which now trails UTEP 10-6 since both teams starting competing against each other in 1972, jumped to a 2-0 lead in the first inning of the second game and led 2-1

after four innings.

Since a high school game was scheduled to begin later in the afternoon, the second game lasted only five innings and the Miners picked the perfect opportunity to unload on Chaps' hurler Richard Nixon who was eventually credited with the loss.

Designated hitter Bill Roberts looked at four pitches before walking down to first and advanced to third when Art Bravo's single behind second base bounced off Brigante's glove which also allowed Bravo to move into scoring position at second.

Dan Haygood, who went 8-for-10 Monday against LCC in a twinbill, tied the score with a deep sacrifice fly to left. An infield error placed Bob Alsop on first and with two outs, Feagler slashed a Nixon pitch deep into the left field corner for an inside-the-park home run and game-winning hit.

"All I was trying to do was just get a hit. A single would have been fine," said Feagler who now leads the Miners with three homes runs.

Miner starter Wes Zoltz won his third game in as many starts.

Feagler's second homer went further than the first which cleared the fence in left-center but Tech Field's left field wall slants outward, making the corner in left the furthest point from home plate.

Feagler knocked in five of UTEP's nine runs for the day while leadoff batter Bravo led the Miners with three hits.

First Game UTEP 4, Lubbock Christian 3

LCC	001	000	2-3	10	4
UTEP	012	100	x-4	6	0

Gary Swann and Charles Casiano: Jerry Walker, Bob Alsop (5), K.C. Nix (6) and Richard Hildebrand. W. Walker (1-0). L. Swann (0-1). HR: UTEP, Dan Feagler.

Second Game UTEP 5, Lubbock Christian 2

LCC	200	00-2	3	1
UTEP	001	04-5	5	0

Richard Nixon and Archie Crim: Wes Zoltz and Richard Hildebrand. W. Zoltz (3-0). L. Nixon (0-1). HR: UTEP, Dan Feagler.